

PAULDING COUNTY HISTORY MUSEUM NEWSLETTER

July 2025

Editor – Judy Wells

This has been an exciting year at the Paulding County History Museum! We've gotten in many new donations, volunteers have stepped up to chair new events and needed repairs have been made to the roof. Gutters were added to keep the rain from running off the building and John Pier has been keeping the lawn looking its finest. Thank you John!

Our next fundraiser will be an Antique Farm Machinery Show, scheduled for Aug. 2 from 10 a.m.-7 p.m. Join us!

We'll have all sorts of antique farm equipment on display, along with hand tools and other equipment that was used back in the day.

At 5, the gospel group "Crossing Jordan" will perform. Bring your lawn chairs and enjoy the show!

And don't miss the great food provided by Fat Pig and members of the museum.

See you August 2!

Antique Farm Equipment Show Replaces

Annual Chicken BBQ

Our next fundraiser will be on August 2 from 10 a.m. until 7 p.m. That's the date we usually have the chicken BBQ each year. But Angie Pollock has decided to retire as chairperson of the BBQ committee. We thank her for her many years of devoted service to the museum in that capacity. There may also be a shortage of chicken at that time because of the bird flu epidemic, so it's been difficult to plan for another BBQ.

The Antique Farm Equipment Show will feature tractors, hit-and-miss engines, harvesters and other farm equipment from an era gone by. There will also be tractor games if the weather permits, an obstacle course at noon with multiple rounds of fun and the Chain Game at 5:30 p.m. In this event, a long chain is attached to the back of each tractor. The driver then pulls forward until the end of the chain is inside a circle drawn on the ground. He then backs up and pulls forward several times until the entire chain is inside the circle. It's challenging for the driver and exciting for the spectators to watch!

Events in the Kid Zone, which will run from 10 a.m. until 3 p.m., include a pedal tractor obstacle course and a pedal tractor teeter-totter. The Junior Fair Board will sponsor a kids' tractor pull. Weigh-in for the pull start at 12:30 with the pull to follow. (*Con't. page 2.*)

Pulled pork sandwiches and yummy sides from the Fat Pig will be served in the dining room of the museum from 11 a.m. until 1 p.m. for lunch. Loaded baked potatoes are on the menu for dinner, served from 4-6 p.m. Desserts and canned soft drinks are included with the meals. All meals are freewill donation.

Crossing Jordan, a gospel music group, will perform at 5 p.m. Bring your lawn chairs and enjoy the music! Other events may be added as time for the show gets closer. This is one of our most important fundraisers of the year and all proceeds benefit the museum. Thanks for your continued support! For more information, contact Guy Dasher, chairman, at 419-796-7269.



Photo by Judy Wells

These antique tractors were owned by Dave Stouffer, a longtime volunteer and director at the museum.

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Melinda Krick resigns as president

At a specially-called meeting of the board of directors and officers of the museum on March 31, 2025, a letter of resignation from president Melinda Krick was read by vice president Mel White.

Mel will fill the vacancy until a new president is elected. The board extends their deepest gratitude to Melinda for her hard work and dedication to the museum during her time as a volunteer and as president.



From the President's Desk

Hello! My name is Mel White and I'm the new president of the Paulding County History Museum. I was elected president June 17 after being vice president for just a few months. Before I was elected VP I was a director for 14 months.

I was born and raised in Paulding and graduated from Paulding High School. My wife, Jennifer and I lived 40+ years in rural Oakwood but now reside in Defiance. I am retired from Vantage Career Center, where I spent 30 years teaching electrical trades. Jennifer and I have been married for 46 years and have two daughters, a son-in-law, a 12-year-old grandson, Dylan, and a new granddaughter.

All of my ancestors were a part of the rich history of Paulding County. Both my grandfathers were successful entrepreneurs in our county. My grandfather, Alpha Grant White, was the first rural mail carrier in Paulding County. He started in 1895. He also ran a small grocery store on the east side of Paulding. My brother, Austin, runs an antique shop there now. My other grandfather, Melvin Cubberly, was a mayor in Cecil and ran a produce business where he would buy products from farmers and bring them into town and sell them. I enjoy history, genealogy, and being a part of our great museum.

I would like to encourage anyone who is interested in helping at the museum to join us on Tuesdays. We work on many projects and events each week and there is always "something to do!" We have a great group of volunteers who are dedicated to keeping the history of our county alive. If you have an interest in working in the office or the barns or helping decorate the museum, come in and join us. I'm sure we can find a job that you will enjoy.

We have many events and fundraisers throughout the year. The museum receives no financial help of any kind. Our fundraisers and donations are what keep the museum afloat. It takes many volunteers to host these events and we can always use more help.

I look forward to working with our dedicated volunteers and getting to know each one better. And I encourage you to visit the museum any Tuesday to enjoy the history of our county.

Remember, it's not junk. It's HISTORY!

Mel R. White, president

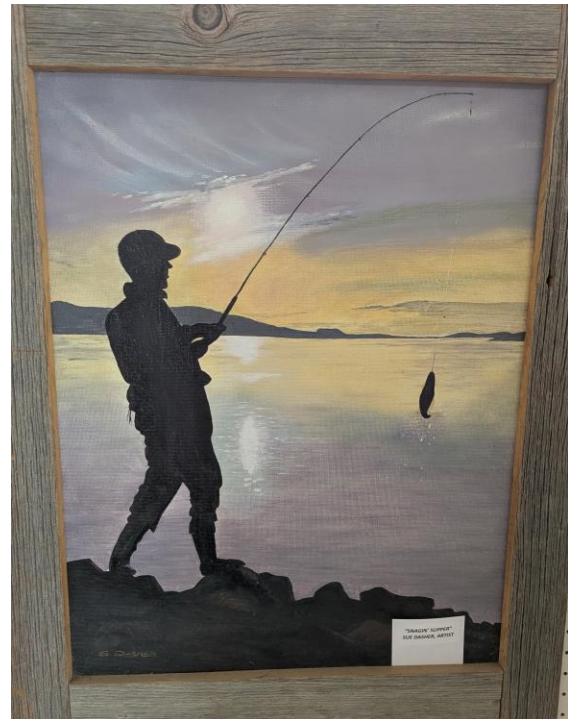
Celebration of Arts and Artists Show Concludes

“Water” was the theme of this year’s **Celebration of Arts and Artists of Paulding County** exhibit. The show was open to all types of media, including pottery, sculpture, photography, paintings, textiles, woodcarving, etc. The show was open to any current or former Paulding County resident, living or deceased.

Photographs and paintings were displayed by nearly 20 artists. In addition, several of the paintings and photographs owned by the museum and done by artists of the county who are deceased, were displayed. Works by Dr. Edith Pritchard, Dr. Edna Preston, Fern White and Otto Earhart were on display as well as photographs and paintings by living

artists from throughout the county. The exhibit ran from May 20 - June 24.

Sue Dasher of Paulding painted this scene of a boy reeling in a fish at sunset. Titled “Snaggin’ Supper,” it was one of about 20 photographs and paintings displayed during the Arts and Artists Celebration.



Quilt Show/Spring Tea Well Received

Our annual quilt show was held April 8, 12 and 15. An estimated 60 quilts, old and new, were displayed throughout the museum. Some were part of the museum’s collection, others were made by members of local quilting clubs. Quilt expert and owner of Born Again Quilts of Fort Wayne, Lois Levihn, gave a presentation on April 8 on restoration and care of fabrics and quilts. The presentation was free and open to the public.

The Spring Tea, held April 5, was attended by nearly 40 guests. Tea and refreshments were served and guests were able to view the quilts before and after the tea. The tea is an important fundraiser for our museum.



Young Woodworkers' Show a Hit



Photo by Judy Wells

This strawberry planter was displayed during the show

The museum's first annual Young Woodworkers' Showcase was a success! Held Saturday May 10, approximately 20 students from area schools participated. The show was open to all woodworkers from Paulding County, ages 18 and under.

"We had everything from derby cars to bird houses, to wooden commemorative flags and deck chairs displayed," said Guy Dasher, chairman of the woodworking committee. "We even had a coffee table and a strawberry planter. For our first year, we had a nice variety of woodworking items. And we gave monetary prizes, so I'm sure most of the students will be back next year. They seemed to be pleased with their winnings."

Winners of this year's woodworking show were Kendra Schroeder, first place. Kendra

attends Paulding High School and won \$150.

Second place went to Jordan Banks, Wayne Trace. Jordan won \$100 for his project.

Third place went to Luke Stouffer, also from Wayne Trace, who won \$50.

Michael Clifford and Landon Dasher of Paulding tied for fourth place and each took home \$40.

All other entrants received \$20 for displaying their works. Sponsors of the show were the Paulding Eagles and Paulding Kiwanis. We thank them for their generous support of our county youth!



Photo by Judy Wells

Dave Brown, father of Elizabeth Miller and a woodworker for many years, shows some of his creations to Mel White during the Woodworkers' Show. Dave was an inspiration to the students who were just learning the trade.



Historical Society Decorates Booth at Paulding County Fair



Photo by Eileen Kochensparger

The Paulding County Fair is in the history books for 2025. And, again this year, our historical society decorated a booth in the Arts and Grange Building at the fairgrounds.

On Tuesday, June 3, Eileen Kochensparger, Sue LaFountain, Elizabeth Miller and Judy Wells loaded their vehicles with wooden stands, red white and blue decorations, flags and military uniforms and memorabilia from all five branches of the service.

Uniforms from the Army, Navy, Air Force, Marines and National Guard were displayed in the fair booth, as well as nurses' uniforms, boots, hats and bags from each branch of the military. All the uniforms and equipment had been donated to the museum by former service members or their families.



First Presbyterian Church Makes Donation to Museum

To celebrate their 150 years of ministry, the First Presbyterian Church of Paulding presented a Legacy Gift of \$150 to the museum and to 13 other organizations in the county, in honor of their members who have been part of the church family for over 50 years.

Carol Razo, on behalf of the church, said of the members, "Their steady faith and dedication represent the legacy we hope to carry forward into the next 150 years." She said the members of the church are grateful for the ongoing service and commitment to our community of the organizations that received the gifts.



Vice president Kim Sutton, far left, and Mel White, president, far right, accepted a \$150 check from Russ and Mary McMaster on behalf of the First Presbyterian Church of Paulding. The church presented Legacy Gifts to 14 organizations in the county in appreciation of their ongoing service and commitment to the community. Members of the 150th Anniversary Committee are Susan Crossland, Jane Nice, Carol Razo and Rebecca Riley.

Help is needed for Festival of Trees

Even though we are in the middle of summer, thoughts at the museum are already turning to this year's Festival of Trees, to be held November 14-22. This year's theme will be "Sparkle and Shine."

One of our dedicated volunteers, Eileen Kochensparger, has resigned from the museum. For many years she was chairman of the Festival committee and did an excellent job of organizing and scheduling entertainment, meals, programs, and activities for the event. For a couple of years, Eileen and Elizabeth Miller were co-chairmen. And last year, Elizabeth and Michelle Stanford were co-chairs. Elizabeth will chair the committee this year.

The Festival of Trees is the museum's largest fundraiser of the year. We need the proceeds of the event to maintain the museum and cover expenses throughout the rest of the year.

Last year, nearly 3,000 visitors came from far and wide to view the trees, enjoy the musical entertainment and share in the variety of meals served. The silent auction was a huge success and the high bidders were excited to take home their prizes. The Ohio State Raffle, sponsored by the Weidenhamer/Borkosky Family in memory of longtime museum president Les Weidenhamer, was another successful event.

If you would be willing to join the committee to help plan the Festival, work in the kitchen, help decorate the museum, make phone calls or send out letters, or assist in any other way, please volunteer your time. Even if you can only help for a few hours or a couple days, we would love to have you! There are many, many jobs to be done to make this year's Festival as successful as past years.

Call the museum on any Tuesday and let us know what you are interested in helping with. Or better yet, just come out and join us! We'll show you around the museum, introduce you to our wonderful volunteers and even share our potluck lunch! We hope to see you soon!



Paulding County History Museum
600 Fairground Drive
P.O. Box 93
Paulding, OH 45879

WE WANT TO HEAR FROM YOU!

Do you have an idea for an event, exhibit or presentation topic?

Your input is appreciated!

Please email your ideas to jphs45879@yahoo.com or talk to any officer or director.